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Dear admissions committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION LETTER FOR VARLEEN NEEMA BIKETI COMMON APP ID:30131041

To have an opportunity to speak about one of my exceptionally gifted students, Varleen Biketi, has me enthralled. The enthusiasm and vitality she brought to my Computer lessons, not forgetting her great intellect that always intrigued me all through the four years, I rank her as my most praiseworthy student yet.

Varleen took a considerable risk in deciding to take Computer as a subject in her first year. At that time, the number of computers in the laboratory was about 26. Being among the last to sign up for the subject, she became twenty-seventh. I suggested that she enroll in another subject with more room, but she declined, asserting that she would not be comfortable in any other subjects. I was worried then, but I am more than thrilled that she stayed. During word processor and spreadsheet practicals in her first year, when it was of most importance that every student do the practicals independently, she could not. She was seated at the corner, taking notes while craning her neck to see the monitor closest to her. After doing this for an entire week of lessons, she came to ask for the computer room keys that Saturday, plus some past practice papers. She went on with this every weekend until she developed such speed in typing that I often requested her to type in some of my work. When I issued the first practical test, I was stunned that she managed to finish in half the time, even working the printer unaided, with all other students needing assistance. For all subsequent lessons, I entrusted her with my laptop during practicals, continually marveling at how she did them with a stroke of genius.

Her input during lessons was profound. As I was teaching algorithms and data structures, I noticed the unique way she generated program flowcharts, a manner that I had only seen at the college level. Having a more simplified version, which translated into the phenomenal pseudocodes she wrote, Varleen made programming language theory more explicit for the rest of the class. Varleen showed independence of thought, occasionally initiating lively class debates on the internet and data security, arguing that network systems in organizations had increased fraudulent practices over the years even though it had made resource sharing and remote communication effortless. She pointed out the vulnerability of their data, citing specific cases of hacking of the Safaricom network in Kenya. Examinations also brought out Varleen's extraordinary reasoning. Though I never informed her, I would often make photocopies of some of her exam papers and keep them among my notes as a reference for other classes because of the more pragmatic answers she gave in specific topics, ranging from artificial intelligence to human-computer interaction. To this day, I carry those papers in my file.

Varleen was very thorough with her work. She once requested more time to complete her assignment on binary systems because she had not gone through her work four times, as she always did. One morning before a computer lesson, she completely disconnected seven computers to place them in their initial stations because she had set the chairs at those particular stations with regard to the student heights. Varleen carried this meticulous character to her group work. She ensured that all members in her group would agree on the database model, the programming language, and even the font type and

size before starting any projects. Varleen would ascertain that every member had a part to play in the group, inquiring individually of their satisfaction. This attention to detail substantiated in the development of holistic database systems, integrating both the spreadsheet and word processor with barely any errors. I almost refer to them with the word perfect.

I have witnessed Varleen grow on the computer. From the time she would be afraid to raise her hand yet she knew the correct answer to the time she would be leading group presentations, three years later. It pained me to let her go; she is a remarkable student with an aggressive zeal to learn more about computers. I can vouch for her being a great addition to your college, as she was in my class.

Yours,



Regina Kiprop

COMPUTER STUDIES TEACHER